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Professional Experience Internship
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Soft Skills Assignment

Directions: Tell me about a time either in an academic setting or a professional work setting where you had to practice effective communication. Who was the communication with? What was the situation? How did you practice effective communication? What was the positive result of this communication? How this situation will prepare you for similar situations in a professional work environment after graduation.

A time when I had to practice effective communication was when I transferred to Florida Poly and had to communicate effectively on getting my classes transferred from my previous college. At the time they registered me with concepts and methods for computer science and applications in Math Emetics. I talked to the registrar and I had to explain my whole situation and show the proof, citing the professors of those classes stating these classes are too basic for me. In the end the registrar agreed and added me to a new course. This will better prepare me for professional work in the future as I learned how to be patient and how to navigate the bureaucratic process. In addition I learned to gather evidence such that when mistakes happen I can document them.

Directions: Tell me about a time either in an academic setting or a professional work setting where you had to use adaptability. What was the situation? How did you adapt to the situation? What was the positive result of being adaptable? How this situation will prepare you for similar situations in a professional work environment after graduation.

I am part of the cyber security club and they had a project that was open to anyone in the club. The project was to create a website for the club, at the time I had never built a website before and I had to adapt to a new workload, which included learning the basics of HTML/CSS/JavaScript in addition to creating assets/images. Many of my club members were in the same situation and as a team supported each other and learned a lot from each other. In a professional work environment I may be introduced into an environment that is new to me. I learned how to deal with unknown environments and how to thrive within one.

Directions: Tell me about a time either in an academic setting or a professional work setting where you had to practice time management skills. What was the situation? How did you practice effective time management skills? What was the positive result of this time management? How will this situation prepare you for similar situations in a professional work environment after graduation.

A setting where time management was hard for me was at a time when I was taking 18 units of classes at University, and I had 2 clubs one was soccer and the other was the cybersecurity club. I was in a difficult time where I had 3 major projects due at the same time, in addition to an upcoming major game tournament coming up. Even though I managed my time as much as I

could, starting early on those projects working every day including weekends for 3 straight weeks in a row I did not have enough time for the soccer tournament. Despite peer pressure I chose the projects over the tournament which was the right decision. In work environments sometimes certain work needs to take priority over another. Having good time management skills will allow me to better manage my time and prioritize the right things.

Directions: Tell me about a time either in an academic setting or a professional work setting where you had to practice and use critical thinking. What was the situation? How did you practice critical thinking? What was the positive result of the critical thinking process? how this situation will prepare you for similar situations in a professional work environment after graduation.

A time where I had to use critical thinking is when I was taking computer systems fundamentals and I was assigned a group to do an assignment which required us to build a complex set of logic gates. We had created up a plan that seemed to work logically however when implementing the logic gates the output was not as expected. The logic gate at first was outputting the correct answer however after two or more steps it suddenly produced the wrong answer. The whole team was perplexed and were looking at every component to see if there were any flaws in the implementation. I had to really think about the project and had found that we missed a fundamental part of the project at the theoretical level, we did not implement the clock cycles correctly. After this fix the project was perfect In work environments there may be situations that there is a small problem that is breaking the project. I will be able to look at what is going wrong and infer what the true problem may be.

Directions: Tell me about a time, either in an academic setting or a professional work setting, where you used resilience. What was the situation? How did you use resilience? What was the positive result of using resilience? How this situation will prepare you for similar situations in a professional work environment after graduation.

The time where I used resilience, is a time where I failed Calculus 1. It was spring 2023 where I took the class and during it, I was really struggling, I was spending all day every day, practicing and reviewing problems yet I still did not understand the material. To put in comparison of how much time I spend on Calculus 1, I was taking 5 classes including calculus. I spent 3 times more time studying Calculus than the 4 other classes I took. I ended up failing several tests and dropping the class. In the following summer I took it again which was double the speed. I was incredibly resilient and had office hours tutoring with the professor every day. I ended up understanding the material and passed the class with a B. In a professional work environment resilience is essential especially with dealing with near impossible tasks. After my experience everything else seems a lot easier to accomplish.

Directions: Tell me about a time either in an academic setting or a professional work setting where you were dependable. What was the situation? How did you practice dependability?

What was the positive result of being dependable? How this situation will prepare you for similar situations in a professional work environment after graduation.

When I was taking programming languages I was put into a project where the team had to create a basic programming language using an unfamiliar language called Plait. Deadlines were coming up over the weekend and my two teammates contacted me saying they cannot contribute to the project due to the game jam being on the same week. I received this message with understanding as I know first hand how much time it takes to make a game, and I promised to fill their spots and complete the project in the weekend. Situations like this will prepare me for work environments as it will make me a valuable employee. I will be the one who is always consistent and can pick up someone who needs it.

Directions: Tell me about a time either in an academic setting or a professional work setting where you had to practice conflict resolution. Who was the conflict with? What was the situation? How did you practice conflict resolution? What was the positive result of this conflict resolution? How this situation will prepare you for similar situations in a professional work environment after graduation.

It was at a time when I was in a group and assigned a big project in a class called Artificial Intelligence. The task was to build a tick-tack-toe game and make a bot for it using several algorithms. I had problems with this group in the past and all of them were procrastinators. Knowing this I started early, saying ideas and plans of what we should do, I did not get any meaningful replies and agreed with everything I said. I worked on the project daily and no one did anything. In the last 2 days I really needed everyone to do their work and they agreed to do their parts. However, on the last day, I found out that only one person had done their parts, so I threatened to contact the professor and that threat made my teammates care and do their parts. In the end I think I handled it well, I am not really sure what is going on with other people's lives so I have a benefit of the doubt for them. Conflict resolution is important in group situations and in the workplace. Having the ability to stand for myself when others are not going in the best faith of their work is a crucial skill.

Directions: Tell me about a time either in an academic setting or a professional work setting where you used problem-solving. What was the situation? How did you problem-solve: what steps did you take? What was the positive result of using problem-solving? How this situation will prepare you for similar situations in a professional work environment after graduation.

A time when I used problem solving skills was when I was doing an assignment in Cisco Packet Tracer which is a full fledged program that virtually configures/manages network equipment, like routers, switches and cables. While setting up a network LAN of a web of routers, I had a problem with OSPF which is a dynamic routing protocol, it is like a map of how to reach every router in the network. I had a problem where one router could not reach another router, knowing

this I started finding out where the fault is. I used a technique where I can ping every router on the path and the last router on the path would be the one that had that problem. I ended up finding the address of the router and it turns out that it was not advertising its protocol. Problem solving is crucial to the work place, every day new problems can occur and having a logical process framework to fix it is important. My logical process is first identify the problem, research it, narrow it down, brainstorm ideas, implement and verify a solution and lastly document it